

STAAR Problem Browser User Guide

Teacher Guide for installing, browsing, filtering, building tests, and printing packets.

This build includes 9 ready collections and 3,642 released STAAR items across Grade 3-6 Math, ELAR, and Grade 5 Science.

Included collections:

- Grade 3 ELAR
- Grade 3 Math
- Grade 4 ELAR
- Grade 4 Math
- Grade 5 ELAR
- Grade 5 Math
- Grade 5 Science
- Grade 6 ELAR
- Grade 6 Math

Use this guide as the PDF that ships with your desktop installers or TPT download.

1. Install and Launch

1. Download the installer that matches your computer. Use the Windows installer on Windows and the Mac installer on macOS.
2. Open the installer and follow the prompts. After installation, launch STAAR Problem Browser from your desktop or applications list.
3. Wait for the startup splash screen to finish. The first collection load may take a moment because the app is preparing local data and images.

The app runs locally after installation. You do not need the original STAAR source PDFs to browse questions, build tests, or print packets.

2. Included Collections

This build currently includes the following ready-to-use collections. Counts are based on the packaged catalog data in this repo.

Collection	Items
Grade 3 ELAR	420
Grade 3 Math	321
Grade 4 ELAR	679
Grade 4 Math	328
Grade 5 ELAR	487
Grade 5 Math	355
Grade 5 Science	150
Grade 6 ELAR	522
Grade 6 Math	380

3. Choose a Collection and Filter Questions

1. Open the collection menu and choose the grade and subject you want to work in.
2. Use the search box when you already know a keyword, TEKS idea, or question stem you want to find quickly.
3. Refine the visible question set with filters such as TEKS, year, difficulty, item type, content, and review status.
4. Watch the summary area as you filter. It updates to show how many questions and passage bundles are still visible.
 - TEKS filter: narrow the catalog to one or more standards.
 - Year filter: focus on recent released questions or compare across years.
 - Difficulty filter: use easy, medium, or hard groups based on state percent-correct data.
 - Item type and content filters: isolate multiple choice, multi-select, constructed response, numeric response, and content strands.
 - Review only: surface items that may need an extra teacher check before printing.

ELAR collections can show passage bundles. If questions share a reading passage or paired passage set, the app keeps those linked resources together.

4. Build a Test Fast

1. Add individual questions from the visible results, or use Add Filtered Questions to bring in the whole filtered set at once.
2. Use built-in presets when you want a quick first draft. Presets include Hardest Test, Easier Test, Latest Questions Only, Spiral Review, Single-TEKS Mastery, Intervention Set, Reteach Set, Benchmark Lite, Mini Quiz, Warm-Up, and Exit Ticket.
3. Enter a test title and teacher or class label so the printed packet is already organized.
4. Reorder questions, remove questions, or swap them out until the packet matches your instructional goal.

5. Print Student Packets and Answer Keys

1. When your selection is ready, choose Print Student Test to create the student-facing packet.
 2. Choose Print Answer Key to print the teacher key with answer choices and metadata.
 3. Review the print preview before sharing. This is the last check for question order, passage grouping, and formatting.
- ELAR passage pages print with their linked questions, including multi-page and paired-passage sets.
 - Teacher answer keys include details such as TEKS, year, item type, difficulty, and state percent-correct information when available.
 - Constructed response and response-template items are preserved in the printable layout.

If a question is marked "needs review" or a passage image is missing, inspect it before giving the packet to students.

6. Common Classroom Uses

- Daily spiral review
- Targeted intervention groups
- Reteach after a quiz or checkpoint
- Benchmark-style mixed review
- Exit tickets and warm-ups
- Single-TEKS mastery practice
- Fast sub plans or station work

7. Troubleshooting

- Startup feels slow: wait through the first collection load. Large local image sets can take extra time to prepare.
- Nothing matches the current filters: clear one or more filters or use Reset Filters to return to the full collection.
- Printing is incomplete: reopen print preview and verify that the selected questions and passage bundles are still visible.
- A passage image is missing: do not use that packet until the linked source image is restored.
- The installer is blocked by the operating system: use the signed installer build that ships with your public release.

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